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Nanjing University of Aeronautics and Astronautics

The Graduate School

College of Foreign Languages

A Report on E-C Translation of The Sensorium of the Drone and Communities (Part III)

A Thesis in

Translation and Interpreting

by

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Advised by

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Submitted in Partial Fulfillment

of the Requirements

for the Degree of

Master of Translation and Interpreting

Communities · Kathrin Maurer The Sensorium of the Drone and
“The Earth”

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ABSTRACT

This translation practice report examines the English-to-Chinese translation of Part III, “The Earth,” from Kathrin Maurer’s academic monograph *The Sensorium of the Drone and Communities*. Situated at the intersection of media studies, environmental humanities, and philosophy of technology, the source text explores how drone sensing participates in the construction of planetary communities, postcarbon communities, and ecological critique in the Anthropocene. It combines informative and expressive functions by presenting technical knowledge of drone remote sensing, landscape surveying, and multispectral imaging while developing a critique of military vision, techno-optimism, and ecological crisis through art, philosophy, and spatial metaphor.

In response to the source text and the supervisor’s comments, this report consolidates the main translation problems into three groups: interdisciplinary terminology and theoretical expressions, complex sentences and argumentative relations, and metaphorical, rhetorical, and related discourse expressions. Drawing on twenty-five authentic source-text examples, it discusses terminology verification and consistency, sentence restructuring and logical clarification, and the adjustment of metaphor and discourse. The analysis shows how these procedures support accurate knowledge transfer while preserving the source text’s argumentative structure and critical stance.

The practice indicates that interdisciplinary academic translation requires terminological, syntactic, and discourse decisions to be made within the same argumentative context. The translator must verify concepts and proper names, limit explanatory additions, and use repeated bilingual review to keep case analyses consistent with the final translation. The report is intended to provide concrete reference for translating English academic texts in media studies, environmental humanities, and philosophy of technology.

Keywords: *The Sensorium of the Drone and Communities*, academic text translation, terminology consistency, sentence restructuring, rhetorical expression

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ABSTRACT.....	I
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1.1

Gregory

“ ” “ ” 1 Chamayou

2

Agostinho Maurer Veel 3

· Kathrin Maurer The Sensorium of the Drone and

Communities “The Earth” 4 2023

“The Earth” “ ” “ ”

“ ” 5 “ ” 6 “ ” 7

17,000

8

9

planetarity sensorium volumetric sensing necroethics postcarbon

communities

《》“The Earth”

1.2

《》“The Earth” 17,000

1

3

planetary sensorium volumetric sensing alterity postcarbon communities

Cabré

¹⁰ Temmerman

¹¹

¹²

¹³

¹⁴

2

¹⁵

¹⁶ ¹⁷ ¹⁸

3

violent blade eye in the sky terrain hugging on loan

¹⁹

²⁰

²¹

1.3

“The Earth”

»

《》 “ The Earth”

2.1

· Kathrin Maurer The Sensorium of the Drone and Communities “The Earth” 4 2023

17,000

Microsoft Word

“ ”“ ”“ ”

1 GB/T 19363.1—2022 23 “ — — — ”

150

Trados Studio 2022

2.2

2.2.1

1 GB/T 19363.1—2022 23

1 17,000

2

“ — — ”

CAT

“ ”

1-2

3 Trados Studio 2022

MIT Press JSTOR CNKI Google Scholar

· Harun Farocki operative images

24 “ ”

2.2.2

“ — — — — ”

Trados Studio 2022

LiDAR photogrammetry point cloud

planetary necroethics postcarbon communities

Trados Studio 2022 QA Checker

Word

“ ”

harvesting the biosphere

2.2.3

sensorium planetary volumetric sensing

Trados

the pencil of nature

Trados MultiTerm TMX

3



《》

8

3.1

.

4

3.1.1

planetary sensorium volumetric sensing alterity operative visuality

10 11

3.1.2

15

16 17 18

3.1.3

flattening violent blade terrain hugging on loan

19

20

Gebrauchsbilder relative

geographies

21

.1

[1]

Research on the scopic regime of military drones often interprets these images as products of an operative form of sensing that dehumanizes, controls, and masters the world.

scopic regime operative sensing “ ”
 scopic regime “ ” “ ” “ ”
 dehumanizes controls masters “ ”

[2]

In contrast to the military drone, the amateur drone’s flattening can evoke interconnectedness instead of control and mastery: the drone can become a medium for planetarity.

planetarity “ ” flattening
 “ ” “ ” interconnectedness “ ”

[3]

This chapter argues that the drone’s flattening gaze has the potential to envision planetary communities.

planetary communities “ ”
 “ ” envision “ ”

[4]

By contrast, for planetary subjects, alterity is not derivative.

alterity “ ” “ ” difference
 singularity “ ” “ ” “ ” derivative

[5]

The sensorium of the drone is also more than visual: Divided presents the sounds of the ocean waves.

《》

《》

sensorium

“ ”

more than visual

“ ” “ ”

[6]

I characterize this multiperspectival sensorium of earth drones as a form of “volumetric sensing” that grasps the three-dimensionality of space.

“ ”

“ ”

“ ”

“

” volumetric sensing sensorium “ ” “ ” that

[7]

Thus the drone functions as what media scholars have called an eco-medium, both registering environmental damage and tracing the materiality of media components.

“ ”

“ ” —

eco-medium

“ ” “

” materiality “ ” “ ”

[8]

In his analysis of planetary art, Terry Smith defines “world scale regimes of seeing” as one aesthetic configuration of the planetary.

“ ”

“ ” . Terry Smith “ ”

world scale regimes of seeing “ ” scopic regime

“ ” “ ” configuration “ ”

[9]

This type of visibility is found in “images for usage” (Gebrauchsbilder), such as graphs, diagrams, and maps.

“ ” Gebrauchsbilder
 “ ” Gebrauchsbilder
 images for usage Gebrauchsbilder “ ”
 “ ”

3.3.2

“ ”

[10]

These imaginaries of postcarbon communities are visions of future collectives where humans, technology, and the earth live together in a more mutually sustainable and ecological relationship.

imaginaries are visions where
 mutually “ — ” “ ” “ ” postcarbon
 communities “ ”

[11]

These communities embody aesthetic attempts to create alternatives to the Anthropocene—or, following Bernard Stiegler, to create training grounds for the more hopeful “Neganthropocene”—providing perspectives, possibilities, and potentials for a more sustainable future and moving beyond the often dead-end and fatalistic discussions about the end of humanity.

“ ”

“ ” — Bernard Stiegler “

Neganthropocene ” —

providing

moving beyond “ ”

[12]

The planetary view does not categorize the earth according to nation-states, international cooperation, or global networks, it sees the people on the planet as one, without making them the same.

as one without making them the same same “ ”

“ ” “ ”

[13]

“Unmannedness” is thus a matter of relative distance and tethering, rather than of physical presence.

“ ”

“ ”

is a matter of... rather than... tethering “ ”

“ ” “ ” tethering “ ”

[14]

Again, the drone sensorium opens up to more-than-optical modes of sensing, integrating sound, rhythm, and music.

more-than-optical “ ” opens up to “ ”
 “ ” “ ” opens up “ ”

[15]

The drone sensorium creates a volumetric interface of earth experience as it sensorially comprises the earth from multiple directions: from the ground to the sky, from within, from a hovering view, and from below.

interface of earth experience sensorially comprises
 “ ” “ ” “ ” comprise
 “ ”

[16]

In other words, these examples of drone art demand a multiperspectival mode of interpretation where meaning oscillates without becoming fixed.

—
 where mode of interpretation “ ”
 “ ” “ ” oscillates

[17]

Thus my approach also relates to Paglen’s statement that drones create their own “relative geographies, folding several noncontiguous spaces around the globe into a single, distributed, battlefield.”

“ ”

“ ”

“ ”

relates to “ ” “ ”

noncontiguous

3.3.3

[18]

Seeing the world from above doesn’t just flatten things. It sharpens them

“ ”

flatten sharpen “ ” “ ”

“ ” “ ” “ ”

[19]

As Fast’s drone pilot says, the flattened drone view sharpens things: it acts like a violent blade that cuts and kills.

violent blade “ ” “ ” “ ”

“ ” “ ” “ ”

[20]

In order to develop this argument, my first step is to historicize the drone, finding “family resemblances” between the drone and hot-air balloons.

“ ”

“ ”

family resemblances

“ ”

“ ”

“ ”

historicize

“ ”

[21]

Thus Drone Vision shows operative images that establish a kill grid, decide about life and death, and dehumanize the subject.

“ ”

kill grid

“ ”

“ ”

“ ” “ ”

decide

dehumanize

[22]

The drone is no longer an aggressive eye in the sky; it volumetrically senses alterations in the landscape due to climate change and provides a potential trajectory for sustainable landscape planning.

eye in the sky

volumetric sensing

“ ” “ ”

“

”

“

”

trajectory

“ ”

[23]

The artists describe this effect as a type of “terrain hugging” in which the drone seems to caress and intimately touch the earth:

“ ”

“ ”

terrain hugging

caress touch

“ ”

“

”

[24]

The planet is the species of alterity, belonging to another system; and yet we inhabit it on loan.

“ ”
“ ”
on loan “ ” “
” belonging “ ” “ ”

[25]

Drones and their volumetric sensoria still have to be handled with care and reflection: they can integrate the human, but they can also expel it.

integrate expel handled “ ” “
” “ ” “ ”

3.4

planetary sensorium volumetric sensing

《》

“ ”

planetary sensorium volumetric

sensing alterity

“ ”

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